

「1 級リスニングテスト」 原稿

ただいまから、1 級リスニングテストを行います。これからお話しすることについて質問は受けませんので、よく注意して聞いてください。このテストでは、テストの方法と注意事項がすべて英語で放送されます。

The listening test for the Grade 1 examination is about to begin. Listen carefully to the directions. You will not be permitted to ask questions during the test.

This test has four parts. All of the questions in these four parts are multiple-choice questions. For each question, choose the best answer from among the four choices written in your test booklet. On your answer sheet, find the number of the question and mark your answer. You are permitted to take notes for every part of this listening test.

Now, here are the directions for **Part 1**. In this part, you will hear 10 dialogues, **No. 1** through **No. 10**. Each dialogue will be followed by one question. For each question, you will have 10 seconds to choose the best answer and mark your answer on your answer sheet. The dialogue and the question will be given only once. Now, let's begin.

(★=男性 A ★★=男性 B ☆=女性 A ☆☆=女性 B)

★No. 1

★★: Hey, Annie! Long time, no see. How's art school going?

☆☆: Pretty well, Mark. I switched my major from fine art to design, and I just got accepted as an intern at a furniture company.

★★: Great! But I thought your real love was sculpture.

☆☆: It is, but I had to face reality. I can make a much better living following this career path.

★★: Do you think it'll satisfy you enough to do it long-term?

☆☆: I guess I'll see how the internship goes.

★Question: Why did Annie decide to change her major?

★★No. 2

★: This TV commercial is absolutely ridiculous.

☆: I think it's great! The expression on the little kitten's face while he's vacuuming is adorable.

★: But what have kittens got to do with household appliances?

☆: Well, what kind of ad would convince you to buy a vacuum cleaner?

★: I want to see how much more powerful it is compared to other brands.

☆: Like a car commercial? Well, I'm sure if the ads targeted men, that's what they'd be like.

★★Question: What does the woman imply?

☆☆No. 3

☆: Mr. Richards just yelled at me because the photocopier was out of paper. It's like everything is my fault!

★★: Don't take it personally. His wife was just diagnosed with cancer. It's got to be tough. Their lives have been turned upside down.

☆: Oh, I had no idea. But why's he taking it out on me?

★★: I don't think it's just you . . . I guess he's feeling pretty helpless right now. You can't

blame him for being a bit irrational occasionally.

☆☆: I guess you're right.

☆☆**Question:** Why did Mr. Richards get angry?

☆☆**No. 4**

☆☆: Hey, Steve. Wasn't that board meeting really frustrating?

★: Yes! Margaret dominated again. Her constant sniping at others and negativity about fresh ideas is hampering the organization.

☆☆: Should we try talking to her?

★: You think she'll listen? We only joined the board a few months ago.

☆☆: True, but we can't just sit back and do nothing. Let's sound out the president and see if he can encourage her to step down.

★: That's a bit drastic. We should rally the other board members around us first.

☆☆: You're right. Then maybe we can push for her resignation!

☆☆**Question:** What do these two colleagues decide to do?

★**No. 5**

★★: I'm afraid we're not going to be able to approve the plan you submitted. According to city zoning ordinances, no structure can be built within 10 feet of the property line.

☆☆: But I've seen parts of town where the buildings are practically on top of each other.

★★: Those buildings were built 40 or 50 years ago, before the enactment of the present zoning laws.

☆☆: I see. So, if I ask my architect to draw up a plan where the foundation is pushed back by another two feet, we should be OK?

★★: Exactly. In that case, there should be no problem with issuing your permit.

★★**Question:** What can be learned from the conversation?

★★**No. 6**

☆: Honey, it's time we took the cat for his annual shots.

★: Can't it wait a month? Things are a little tight at the moment.

☆: Well, doing it now means we might avoid more expensive problems down the road.

★: Our regular vet charges a lot. How about we try a new clinic?

☆: I'd rather not—Doug's been our vet for years. I could ask about a payment plan, though.

★: You should do that. It would really help if we could sort it out in installments.

★★**Question:** What do these people decide to do?

☆☆**No. 7**

☆: I see you're reading Susan Horn's latest novel.

★★: Actually, I just finished it. Have you read it?

☆: Yes, but I wasn't that impressed.

★★: Really? I thought it was pretty good. I liked the interesting characters and the plot twists.

☆: Me, too. But the way she wrapped it up didn't make any sense to me.

★★: Really? I enjoyed the way it turned out. I was surprised when I found out who the murderer was, but looking back, there were a lot of clues.

☆: I guess I should pay more attention to the details.

☆☆: **Question:** What is the woman's opinion of the book?

☆No. 8

☆☆: Hey, Bill. Long time no see. Did you end up getting that new house you were talking about?

★: I wish. It was all going so smoothly—they accepted our offer and the mortgage loan was all arranged. But just before it was finalized, everything fell through.

☆☆: Why? What happened?

★: The deal was based on us selling our house by the end of last month, but our buyer backed out at the last minute.

☆**Question:** What do we learn about the man?

★No. 9

☆: I noticed you cycled to work again today, Jim. You're really committed to using your car less.

★★: I am, Sally. It's good all-around—I'm polluting less, saving on gas, and getting more exercise.

☆: Well, you're not alone. I read an article the other day about how America's love affair with the automobile is waning.

★★: Really?

☆: Yeah. I saw one poll that said 18- to 24-year-olds are far more interested in having a computer and Internet access than in owning a car.

★★: Wow! All I ever wanted when I was a kid was my first car.

☆: But it's not just the youngsters: attitudes certainly do seem to be changing with us older folks . . .

★★: Hey, less of the old!

☆: Sorry! But attitudes have shifted. Our generation is no longer interested in the idea of expanding the road network. It just leads to more environmental damage in the long run.

★★: True enough. Now if the politicians would only allocate more funds to improving public transportation!

☆: Yeah, and it'd do more than ease traffic congestion. The article said public transportation projects create more jobs than road construction.

★★: Hmm Unfortunately, politicians are lobbied by industry to allow more and more cars on the road.

☆: Perhaps one day they'll pay more attention to what's best for us, and less time pandering to special interests.

★**Question:** What does the man think about politicians?

☆☆No. 10

★: You know, we really need to come to a decision about our supplier.

☆: I say we suspend our orders. They've sent us two late shipments in a row!

★★: Yeah, but their low prices save us a bundle, Kim.

★: So . . . if we drop them and get our material elsewhere, our production prices will go up.

☆: Exactly. And they know that.

★★: Sounds to me like they've got us between a rock and a hard place.

☆: But that's why I say we should dump them immediately.

★: But, Kim, I don't think that makes sense. I have a pretty good relationship with Mr. Wallace, their sales manager. I could talk with him again.

☆: Look. I don't think they'll budge unless we take action. Remember, we're a big customer and it wouldn't look good for them if they lost our business.

★: I don't know. That sounds rash. Let's give my idea a chance.

★★: I disagree. This has gone on long enough. I'm with Kim on this. We pull the plug until they realize their error. They shouldn't treat us like this.

☆: All right, then. That's settled. It's a gamble, but I think it'll pay off.

★: OK, then. I just hope you're right.

☆☆**Question:** What have these three people decided to do?

Here are the directions for **Part 2**. In this part, you will hear five passages, (A) through (E). Each passage will be followed by two questions, **No. 11** through **No. 20**. For each question, you will have 10 seconds to choose the best answer and mark your answer on your answer sheet. The passage and the questions will be given only once. Now, let's begin.

☆☆(A) *Mouse Tunes*

It is known that male mice vocalize in certain situations, such as when they are seeking mates. Because most squeaks are too high-pitched for the human ear, however, they have never been studied in depth. Thanks to recent advances in audio technology, Timothy Holy and Zhongsheng Guo of the Washington University School of Medicine have become the first researchers to record and analyze the vocalizations of male mice. The scientists used computer software to lower the pitch of the vocalizations when analyzing the squeaks, and they were surprised to find that the mice seemed to be singing.

Holy and Guo had intended to investigate how male mice responded behaviorally to chemical signals released by females. The males' vocalizations were so interesting, however, that the researchers instead focused on them exclusively. Holy and Guo admit that mouse songs are less sophisticated than those of songbirds, but they do meet the two criteria that qualify vocalizations as songs. First, they contain different kinds of sounds. Second, they include recognizable phrases that are repeated, much like the chorus in a pop song. Researchers now hope to determine whether male mice actually have to learn these songs from one another as they grow up or whether they produce them instinctively.

★**Questions**

★**No. 11** Why were mouse vocalizations not analyzed earlier?

★**No. 12** What is still unknown about male mice?

★★(B) *Arctic Acidification*

Approximately one-quarter of global carbon dioxide emissions are absorbed by the world's oceans. Most scientists believe that while this has helped slow down climate change, it is also making our oceans more acidic. Recent research shows that the Arctic Ocean is absorbing CO₂ faster than other oceans. The resulting acidification may lead to a decline in animal populations, including herring, cod, crabs, sea urchins, and plankton. Researchers say this would threaten the livelihoods of indigenous peoples, who depend on hunting and fishing. It would also diminish food sources for birds and larger marine mammals such as seals.

Several factors make the Arctic Ocean especially vulnerable to acidification. For one thing, it is cold, and cold water is better at absorbing CO₂. Additionally, rising air temperatures have reduced the Arctic's ice cover. This has exposed more ocean water to the atmosphere and increased the rate of absorption of CO₂. Also, due to the increasing amounts

of melting ice, cold water is flowing into the ocean more rapidly. Scientists fear it may now be too late to prevent further acidification, even if CO₂ emissions were stabilized immediately.

☆Questions

☆No. 13 What is one thing researchers say?

☆No. 14 What is one reason the Arctic Ocean is vulnerable to acidification?

☆(C) Copycat

The idea that we are affected by the people around us is not new. For example, we know that people feel happy when those around them are happy and that teenagers often start smoking because their friends smoke. Some public-health experts are now hoping to use this phenomenon to spread positive health messages. One such expert, Dr. Nicholas Christakis of Harvard Medical School, thinks this can be achieved by targeting key members of social groups, who will then spread the messages to other members. The challenge, he says, is finding the people who have the most influence.

Dr. Thomas Velente of the University of Southern California carried out an experimental smoking-prevention program with groups of high school students. All groups were led by peers. The peer leaders were nominated by their class, by a teacher, or chosen at random. One year after all the leaders stopped smoking, the groups with class-nominated leaders showed the biggest drop in smoking rates. However, results in a follow-up study meant to discourage drug abuse suggested that the group leader's role was not as relevant. Velente says this shows that it might be important to design specific programs based on what is being targeted.

★★Questions

★★No. 15 What is Dr. Nicholas Christakis hoping to do?

★★No. 16 What do the results of Dr. Thomas Velente's research suggest?

★(D) Allergy Alert

In recent years, some developed countries have experienced a significant rise in the rate of allergies, a sign of immune-system malfunction. Some studies have indicated that exposure to harmless bacteria is vital in regulating the immune system. In a recent study conducted in Finland, for example, it was found that teenagers with common allergies had fewer kinds of nonpathogenic, or "friendly," bacteria on their skin than teenagers without allergies. Furthermore, the study revealed a positive correlation between the diversity of friendly bacteria on the skin and growing up in an environment with a variety of native plants. Subjects living in rural settings had more friendly bacteria and were less sensitive to allergens.

To reduce the occurrence of allergies, researchers recommend spending time in environments with a wide variety of native plants. This is often easier said than done, though, especially in urban areas. Some researchers therefore aim to isolate and reproduce the friendly bacteria. This may make it possible to build a healthy immune system for people who would otherwise not have one. Ultimately, though, researchers suggest that the most cost-effective solution is to focus on preserving biodiversity in nature and increase green spaces in urban environments to expose people to friendly bacteria.

☆☆Questions

☆☆No. 17 What did the study in Finland reveal about allergies?

☆☆No. 18 What is one way researchers believe the situation can be improved?

☆☆(E) A Fair Deal?

When consumers in wealthy countries purchase products certified by the Fairtrade

Foundation, they pay a small premium. The foundation requires producer organizations in developing countries to use profits from the premium to improve the conditions and rights of their growers and workers. Some analysts, however, say this does not always happen. For example, a significant percentage of Fairtrade-labeled bananas from the Dominican Republic are harvested by illegal Haitian workers. On Fairtrade and conventional banana plantations alike, most Haitian workers are given no opportunities for advancement, are paid barely enough to eat, and have no legal status in the Dominican Republic.

The U.K. Fairtrade Foundation acknowledges that many workers live in harsh conditions, but blames supermarket-chain price wars. It says that in order to attract customers, supermarkets are offering products such as bananas for unrealistically low prices. So even after receiving the small premium, Fairtrade producers are unable to improve working conditions. A bill recently enacted in the U.K. aims to remedy this situation by limiting supermarkets' ability to artificially lower their prices. Unless the law is rigorously enforced, however, it will remain difficult for Fairtrade producers to ensure their products live up to their name.

★★Questions

★★No. 19 What do some analysts say about Fairtrade products?

★★No. 20 What does the speaker say is the goal of the recent U.K. law?

Here are the directions for **Part 3**. In this part, you will hear five passages, (F) through (J). The passages represent real-life situations and may contain sound effects. Each passage will have one question, **No. 21** through **No. 25**. Before each passage, you will have 10 seconds to read the situation and question written in your test booklet. After you hear the passage, you will have 10 seconds to choose the best answer and mark your answer on your answer sheet. The passage will be given only once. Now, let's begin.

☆ (F) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 21.

★ Hi Takahiro, it's 9 a.m. Wednesday morning. I know you're off, but I need your help. There's a translated brochure that's being sent for its first draft printing at 4 p.m. today. The thing is, I just found out it was done by the new intern. It may be OK, but I need you to look it over. I have sent copies of the Japanese original and the English translation to your e-mail. You can make corrections directly to the file if you can get the translation back to me before the deadline. If not, we can still make changes after we get the printer's draft on Friday. In that case, I'll e-mail you a copy of the draft then. You can print it out at home, mark up any corrections, and fax it back to me by Monday. Really sorry about this, but thanks.

☆ Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

★★ (G) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 22.

☆ First off, tide conditions can make a big difference. For example, fish like flounder are easier to catch when the tide's low. You can check newspapers for tide conditions or just ask at a local fishing shop. In the summer, when you're going, sunlight's a big factor. Fish usually prefer less light, so they won't bite much around the middle of the day. This definitely applies to sea bass. They tend to be most active in the early mornings and early evenings. There is often a slight breeze at those times, too, and they'll come closer to the surface to feed then. Cloudy days might appear to be good because there's less sunlight, but the temperature usually drops significantly, so they'll be less likely to bite.

★★ Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

☆☆(H) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 23.

★★ OK. Since you've supplied a police report proving the accident occurred, we can waive the rebooking fee, so that will save you \$50. If there's a fare difference, however, you'll be responsible for that, of course. Let me take a look at the computer . . . OK, there are only a few seats left on tomorrow's flight. It's a weekday fare, so you wouldn't have to pay any extra charges. But they're all in economy class. The following day is a Friday, which is a peak day. We have one business-class seat available, but that would cost you an additional \$250. If you want it, I recommend you book now. The \$250 price increase also applies for Saturday and Sunday flights. Monday's ticket price drops back down to the weekday fare. It looks like there are seats available in both business and economy class for Monday.

☆☆ Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

★ (I) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 24.

☆☆ Visit Wildlands Amusement Park this summer for some wild fun! One-day passes are only \$50 per adult and \$30 per child. Or why not take advantage of our two-day passes? These are just \$80 per adult and \$45 per child. Summer season passes are also now on sale. For \$150 per adult and \$120 per child you can get unlimited admittance from June through August! Passes are available on our website or at the ticket office. All major credit cards are accepted. Also, Bloomfield residents can receive 10 percent off all ticket prices. Just make the purchase in person at the ticket office and bring a photo ID. Finally, don't miss our 20th anniversary celebrations from July 3rd to July 7th, when all tickets will be half price for five days.

★ Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

☆ (J) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 25.

★ There are basically four types of TV these days: projection, plasma, LED, and LCD. They all have their pros and cons, of course. Now, if this will be your TV for your living room, I'd suggest at least a 40-inch screen. A projection TV would offer the biggest flexibility in terms of size for your money, but the image clarity will be lower than the other options. Plasma TVs are popular for their warmer picture color. These are best in a darker viewing environment, though, because the screen's glass reflects light, which puts some people off. As for LCDs and LEDs, they're quite similar in most departments. LEDs come with a considerably steeper price tag. In terms of picture quality, however, there is little difference between the two: they're both crystal clear.

☆ Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

Finally, here are the directions for **Part 4**. In this part, you will hear an interview. The interview will be followed by two questions, **No. 26** and **No. 27**. For each question, you will have 10 seconds to choose the best answer and mark your answer on your answer sheet. The interview and the questions will be given only once.

★ Now, let's listen to the interview. This is an interview with Eric Due, who used to work on the U.S. railroads.

Interviewer (I): Hey, welcome to the studio, Eric.

Eric Due (ED): Thanks.

I: So, tell us about your work on the railroad.

ED: Well, I worked from fall of 1976 through the spring of 1987, was hired as a brakeman-switchman, later was promoted to conductor status, but generally would rotate among all three jobs.

I: I see. What role do you think railroads play in American society?

ED: Well, they are, I mean, most people probably associate deliveries and shipment of freight with trucks. But in real terms, trains handle a vast amount of equipment and materials, raw materials and whatnot, and were the railroads to shut down, the trucks would never be able to fill up the gap that is provided by the delivery of, of commodities by rail. So in terms of commerce alone, the railroads play a very key part, and they are now streamlined down to the point where, it's, for example, quicker for a ship to arrive at San Francisco, unload its cargo onto 10 trains and have those 10 trains take that cargo to New York, than it would be for the ship to go through the Panama Canal and up to New York.

I: Of course. What do you think about attempts to introduce high-speed rail in the United States?

ED: It's becoming sensible to have high-speed rail connections. And, there are places where it, it geographically would work and could compete quite well against, for example, air travel. And nobody really likes traveling on a bus, I don't think, as far as I know. But it's been a political issue. For, for example, the Obama administration has wanted to introduce high-speed rail as an incentive for states to A, put people to work building these systems, and to accept government subsidies for this, and B, then to actually maintain the systems. And so that has, President Obama for, has been one of the few who have been an advocate of high-speed rail, and of course he's met a lot of resistance from his opposition party to these initiatives. And there are a lot of conflicting interests in play that perhaps have been the root cause for that problem.

I: OK. Well, thank you for being with us today, Eric. It's been nice talking with you.

ED: Oh, thank you, too, for having me.

★★Questions

★★No. 26 What does Eric think about transportation in America today?

★★No. 27 What is one thing that Eric suggests regarding high-speed rail?

Your time is up. Stop writing and wait quietly until the answer sheets have been collected.

では、時間です。筆記用具を置いて答えの記入をやめてください。試験監督者に連絡いたします。これより最終の受験者数を確認してください。その後、解答用紙を回収し枚数の確認を行ってください。受験者数と解答用紙の枚数の一致を確認してから、解散の指示を出してください。受験者の皆さんは、身のまわりをよく点検し、忘れものがないように注意してください。受験者の皆さんが退出するときは、別の教室が試験中の場合もありますので、声を出さず、校舎出口まで静かに退出してください。それでは、解散の指示を出すまで静かにお待ちください。